

SPECIAL NOTICE DARPA-SN-26-60

Disruption through Intelligent Strategies, Counter Options, and Resilient Defenses (DISCORD) Proposers Day

EVENT DATE: 7 May 2026, 9:30 AM – 5:00 PM Eastern Time (ET)

REGISTRATION DEADLINE: 28 APRIL 2026, 3:00 PM ET

REGISTRATION WEBSITE: <https://creative.spa.com/darpa/sto/discord/pd/>

TECHNICAL POC: Dr. Eric Davis, STO Program Manager

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PROPOSERS DAY:

DARPA will host a Proposers Day in support of DARPA-PS-26-27, the DISCORD program on 7 May 2026 at the SPA Arlington Research Collaboration Center (SPARCC), 4075 Wilson Blvd., Arlington, Virginia 22203 from 9:30 AM to 5:00 PM ET. The purpose of this conference is to provide information on the DISCORD program; promote additional discussion on this topic; address questions from potential proposers; and provide a forum for potential proposers to present their capabilities for teaming opportunities.

PROGRAM OBJECTIVE AND DESCRIPTION: The objective of the DISCORD program is to develop an Artificial Intelligence (AI)-native¹ tactics engine that can incorporate live sensor data and high-fidelity simulation to rapidly generate tactics that continuously adapt to changes in the operational environment. The goal is to provide commanders with a portfolio of diverse strategies that can pivot dynamically in response to evolving conditions.

The DARPA DISCORD effort implements Ender's Foundry, one of several warfighting Pace-Setting Projects (PSPs) established by the Department of War. Ender's Foundry's intent is to accelerate AI-enabled simulation capabilities to ensure we stay ahead of AI-enabled adversaries.

REGISTRATION INFORMATION: DARPA hosts Proposers Days to promote teaming arrangements between researchers; provide potential performers with information on whether and how they might respond to the Government's research and development solicitations; and to increase efficiency in proposal preparation and evaluation. Therefore, Proposers Days are open only to registered potential proposers.

Participants must register NLT 3:00 PM ET on 28 April 2026 at the following website: <https://creative.spa.com/darpa/sto/discord/pd/>. Due to space limitations of the conference facility, attendance will be limited to the first 80 registrants, and no more than 2 representatives per organization. Directions to the facility and other materials are also available on the website. There is no registration fee for attending this conference.

The DISCORD Proposers Day will include Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI) and all attendees must be either U.S. Citizens or U.S. Persons. It is important to understand that a non-U.S. citizen can either be a foreign person or a U.S. person.

¹ AI-native refers to shifting workflows the same way computer-native workflows did in the 1980s, and internet-native workflows did in the 2000s. The new technologies must be developed and incorporated into workflows as a first principle, fully enabling the warfighter in the 21st century to fight with AI tools custom built for DoW purposes.

- A foreign person is any person who is not a lawful permanent resident of the United States, e.g., students or employees legally in the U.S. with a valid student or work visa.
- A U.S. person, which includes those known as “Green Card holders”, is a person who is a lawful permanent resident of the United States or who is a protected individual as defined by 8 U.S.C.1101(a)(20) or 8 U.S.C.1324b(a)(3).

CUI managed by DARPA, to include CUI that is NOFORN or EXPORT CONTROLLED, may be disclosed to U.S. Persons if they are a performer on a DARPA S&T proposal team or, if they are a performer who has been awarded a DARPA S&T project and their sponsoring institution has agreed to comply with DoD CUI policies and procedures as detailed in either DoD 5200.48, DFARS 252.204-7012, 7019, and 7020, or similarly acceptable guidance and direction.

All non-U.S. Citizen registrants must complete and submit a DARPA Form 60. All DARPA Form 60s must be submitted no later than 3:00 PM on 28 April 2026.

Upon entry to a physical meeting, all attendees will be required to present valid, Government-issued photo identification. Examples of approved forms of ID are available at the DARPA Visitor Information page.

Attendees who would like to present company overviews, discuss their technology expertise, and/or discuss teaming opportunities in scheduled presentations at the meeting should contact DISCORD@darpa.mil as soon as possible, but no later than the registration cutoff date for the Proposer Day. Presentations are limited to three (3) minutes each (including logistical issues) and only one (1) Microsoft PowerPoint slide (no build, no animation). Please include your contact information on your slide in a legible font.

All material to be displayed at Proposers Day must be approved in advance by both the organization that funded the research and the DARPA Program Manager. The DARPA Program Manager will screen the proposed material for sensitive but unclassified material and approve in advance any presentations. It is the presenter’s responsibility to ensure that all material they plan to present at the Proposers Day has been approved by the funding organization in advance. An electronic copy of all material to be presented must be provided to DISCORD@darpa.mil no later than 3:00 PM ET on 30 April 2026. There will be no exceptions to this requirement. Companies are free to present, but DARPA does not sponsor that information on the Agency website.

DARPACONNECT: For those new to DARPA or national security, DARPA makes available a free, comprehensive resource via DARPAConnect on how to do business with the agency. In addition to DARPA 101 materials, relevant preparatory modules include “Making the Most of a Proposers Day” and “Understanding DARPA Broad Agency Announcements.” Registration and access are free at <http://www.darpaconnect.us/>.